A little typing. A little magic.

KeyCritter

Your tiny typing companion

Presented by Eric Han



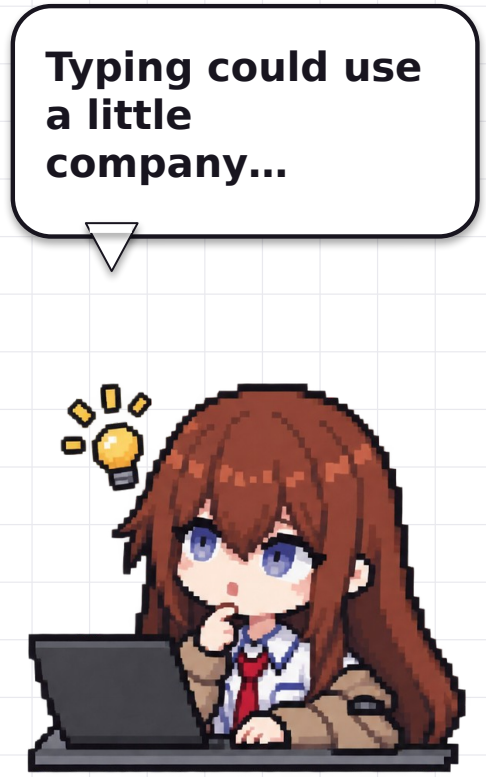
Problems while typing?

Repetition

Long typing sessions can feel repetitive.

Personalization

Users may want a workspace that reflects their interests.



What if a companion reacted as you typed?

Creative process

01 Idea
Define the companion and its visual style.



02 Design
Plan the library, room, and key reactions.



03 Build
Connect artwork, typing, saving, and desktop use.



04 Improve
Test behavior, fix bugs, and refine the experience.

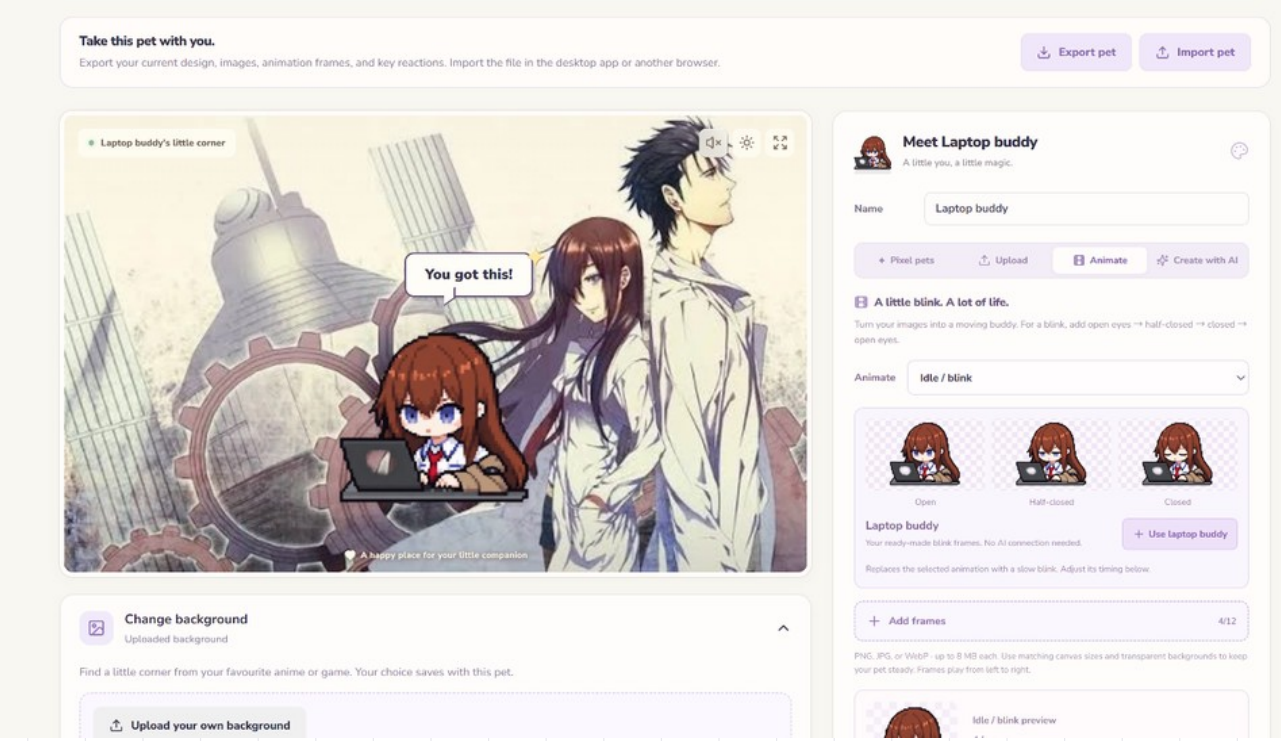


Idea → Design
Build → Improve



01 IDEA

Demo time!



Try it

1. Choose
2. Style
3. Type
4. Save

Let me show you around!



500 characters • 10 pose previews each • 22 scenes

Tools and technology

React + TypeScript

Interface and pet behavior

Vite

Build the website

Electron

Windows desktop app

GitHub + Actions

Track code and publish

Playwright

Browser tests and checks

Codex / AI tools

Development assistance

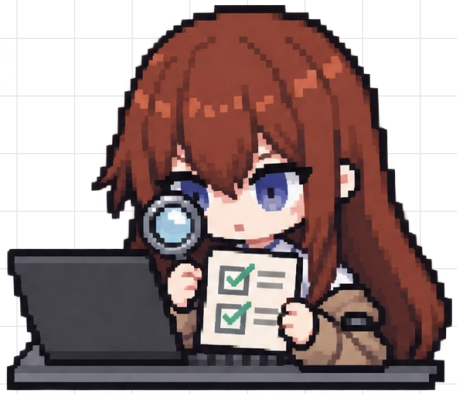
These tools brought me to life.



Comparing virtual companions

Feature	KeyCritter	Clippy	Codex Pet
Animated companion	✓	✓	✓
Desktop application	✓	✓	✓
Choose characters	✓	✓	✓
Upload pet artwork	✓	✕	✓
AI-assisted pet creation	✓	✕	✓

Let’s compare our features.



Our focus: custom typing reactions and illustrated rooms.

Scope: classic Office assistants and the supplied built-in Codex pet selector.

Challenges faced

Artwork

Keep characters recognizable.

Use references and visual review.

Library size

Avoid loading every image at once.

Load small batches on demand.

Saved settings

Keep changes when updating or transferring.

Use migration and export/import.

This part took some debugging…



“Key” takeaways

Listen

Turn feedback into clear improvements.

Test

Find the real cause using evidence.

Preserve

Add features without losing saved work.

What did we learn?



A working feature must also work for existing users.

Skills developed

Interface planning

Organize features into a clear user journey.

Data organization

Manage characters, images, and saved designs.

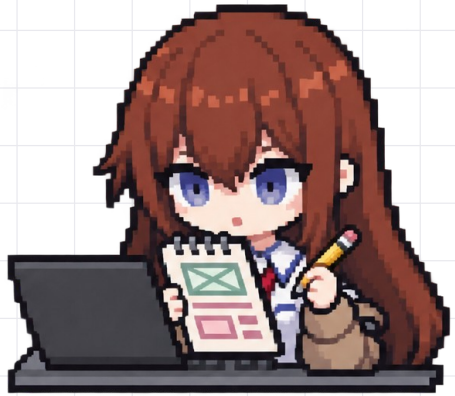
Testing + debugging

Check behavior and investigate problems.

AI-assisted workflow

Direct, review, and refine generated output.

There’s more to explore!



Next: more user testing and clearer first-use guidance.

Thank you!

A little company. A lot of personality.

Thanks for meeting me!



yana20091011.github.io/web

Try it, or ask a question!